

DEDUCTIVE REASONING

BASIC CONCEPTS

- In statement-conclusion, a paragraph or a statement is given to us and based on that we must derive certain conclusions.
- Now what is a conclusion? So, a conclusion is a judgement or a decision which is derived after sufficient reasoning. In our context, conclusions are logical facts that are derived or inferred from the passage.

IMPORTANCE OF THIS TOPIC

- This is one of the most important topic in logical reasoning.
- It is a very important topic for placements in IT Companies.
- Questions from this topic are asked in almost all the examinations like IT Placements, CAT, NMAT, SNAP, MAT, CMAT, CET etc.

STEPS TO SOLVE

- Read the passage or given statements thoroughly.
- Analyze each statement individually.
- Draw a logical conclusion based on the given statement.

SOME IMPORTANT POINTS

- Conclusion and Inference are one and the same thing.
- Do not use your general knowledge.
- Conclusion should only be as per the given statement, so we do not need to find a conclusion which is true in general, but we do need to find a statement which is true for the given statement.

TIPS AND TRICKS

Statement: Teacher scolded Ram in front of all the students.

Conclusion: The teacher disliked Ram

TIP No. 1 : DO NOT ASSUME

Only Make those assumptions that can be drawn or inferred from the given passage or statements. Do not assume anything which is not related to the passage.

Statement: Teacher scolded Ram in front of all the students.

Conclusion: The teacher disliked Ram

Explanation: Here, given statement is the teacher scolded Ram but no specific reason is mentioned. It can be because Ram was late to attend the class or Ram did not complete his homework. So just by assuming that the teacher disliked Ram and so she scolded him is totally wrong. So, avoid such conclusions.

TIPS AND TRICKS

Statement: With the increase in consumption of petroleum products, it is feared that petrol will be a rare commodity in near future.

Conclusion: Petroleum Products should be used efficiently.

TIP No. 2 : ADVICE OR RESULT

If a given conclusion is in advice form or a certain result can be deduced out of it then such a conclusion will always be true. But of course, the conclusions should be related to the given statement.

Statement: With the increase in consumption of petroleum products, it is feared that petrol will be a rare commodity in near future.

Conclusion: Petroleum Products should be used efficiently.

Explanation: Here the given conclusion is in advice form. So such a conclusion is always true.

TIPS AND TRICKS

Statement: Many people have been admitted in the hospital. It is assumed that junk food is poisonous.

Conclusion: Junk food is always poisonous.

TIP No. 3 : AVOID PRE-ASSUMPTIONS

If a given conclusion contains a "Pre-Assumption"
then such a conclusion is always wrong.

Statement: Many people have been admitted in the hospital. It is assumed that junk food is poisonous.

Conclusion: Junk food is always poisonous.

Explanation: Now as per the given conclusion, it is very clear that we are trying to make a "Pre-Assumption" based on the unhealthy effects of junk food. So, such "Pre-Assumed" conclusions are always wrong.

TIPS AND TRICKS

Statement: Many Medicines contain Fish oil.

Conclusion:

1. All the vegetarians are also Pescatarians.
2. Some vegetarians consume such medicines to cure their diseases.

TIP No. 4 : DO NOT GO BY MORALS / ETHICS

For certain questions, when you go by the options for finding out an appropriate conclusion, sometimes it may happen that the answer option may not be morally correct, still that will be the correct answer. So, if an option is related to the statement and if you find it to be it logically correct then that option should be selected even if it is morally incorrect.

Statement: Many Medicines contain Fish oil.

Conclusion:

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TIP No. 4 : DO NOT GO BY MORALS / ETHICS

Statement: Many Medicines contain Fish oil.

Conclusion:

1. All the vegetarians are also Pescatarians.
2. Some vegetarians consume such medicines to cure their diseases.

Explanation: Correct option is 2nd one. So even if the option is not morally correct as vegetarians should not consume fish but to cure certain diseases it is necessary to consume such medicines. So, some conclusions like the one given above are correct even if they are morally incorrect but are logically correct and are related to the given statement.

Q. **Statement:** An advertisement of TCS NQT –
"If you are a software engineer we want to hire you".

Conclusion:

1. TCS hires no person with other qualification.
2. TCS is in need of software engineers.

- (A) If only conclusion 1 follows
- (B) If only conclusion 2 follows
- (C) If either 1 or 2 follows
- (D) If neither 1 nor 2 follows and
- (E) If both 1 and 2 follow.

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Correct Option: (B)

Option no 1 is not appropriate as nothing is mentioned in the statement about TCS not hiring people from any other profession.

Q. **Statement:** India is a democratic country.

Conclusion:

1. No other country in the world is democratic.
2. There are many other countries in the world that are democratic.

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- (B) If only conclusion 2 follows
- (C) If either 1 or 2 follows
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Correct Option: (D)

Neither 1 nor 2 follows. This is because in the statement, nothing is mentioned about other countries. The statement only talks about India.

Q. **Statement:** Shyam is one of the probable students for securing 1st rank in the class.

Conclusion:

1. Shyam will secure 1st rank.
2. Shyam will not secure 1st rank.

- (A) If only conclusion 1 follows
- (B) If only conclusion 2 follows
- (C) If either 1 or 2 follows
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Correct Option: (C)

Either 1 or 2 follows. As the statement says, only 2 possible outcomes are possible. One Shyam will be 1st in his class or he won't be. But both the things cannot happen simultaneously. Hence option C is appropriate.

Q. **Statement:** An advertisement-
"50% off on all Electronic Goods up till 31st January".

Conclusion:

1. After 31st January, no discount will be provided.
2. No sale of electronic goods after 31st January.

- (A) If only conclusion 1 follows
- (B) If only conclusion 2 follows
- (C) If either 1 or 2 follows
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Correct Option: (A)

Option 2 is not valid as the statement clearly says that the sale is up till 31st Jan. Nothing like the sale of electronic goods will stop after 31st Jan is mentioned. So only option no 1 follows.

Q. **Statement:** Due to recession,
Company X has fired its 200 employees.

Conclusion:

1. Company X is well known for firing people.
2. All other competitors of Company X are also affected because of recession.

- (A) If only conclusion 1 follows
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- (C) If either 1 or 2 follows
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- (D) If neither 1 nor 2 follows and
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Correct Option: (D)

Neither 1 nor 2 follows. Company X has fired its employees because of current recession. Nothing is mentioned about the history of the company X. So, option 1 is false.

The competitors may or may not be affected because of recession. We are not aware of that fact. So, option no 2 is also false.